Bukhari Chancery Persian Textbook Development

conjectural_me-gist

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Grammatical Explanation

Central Asian Persian has a special verbal mode to express likelihood or expectation, which it shares with Central Asian Turkic languages such as Uzbek and Uyghur. This construction is common in both spoken Tajik and Central Asian Persian chancery documents, but less common in Central Asian Persian manuscripts.

The basic form is: the continuous particle (mē) + past participle (e.g., karda) + gī + ast. In other words, it is the می form of the -gi participle (see chapter [[]]) followed by the copula. For instance: او می‌رفته‌گی‌است, '(s)he will probably go', '(s)he probably goes', or '(s)he is expected to go'. In colloquial Tajik, this would be compounded as: мерафтагист. The copula agrees with the subject: in the plural, می‌رفته‌گی‌اند, 'they will probably go'.

[[rewrite, but keep main idea: can be used in past tense as well; NM confirms that you can soften the probability with boshad]] The same می form of the -gi participle also combines with other forms of 'to be', each with its own shade of meaning. With بود it means 'was supposed to' (میرسیده گی بود, 'was to reach'); with شود it gives an instruction (می استاده گی شود, '[he] is to remain'); with باشد it states a condition (اگر میفرستاده گی باشند, 'if they are going to send'); and with میباشد

it describes what someone is like or able to do (میبرامیده گی میباشد, 'is capable of handling'). Each matches Uzbek -adigan with the corresponding form of 'to be' (yetadigan edi, turadigan bo'lsin, yuboradigan bo'lsa, uddasidan chiqadigan).

[[really it has lost this meaning: either explain, or just leave this paragraph out; at this point rafta ast and raftagi ast mean the same thing]] Without می, the plain -gi participle with است expresses a conjecture about the past, or about a present state inferred from it: داشته گیست, 'she must have [relatives]'. Compare Tajik хӯрдагист, '(s)he has probably eaten'.

[[need to update this language: at this point, according to NM native speaker of both, me-rafta-gi-ast is closer to boradigan ekan; Uyghur Hahn p. 606 has boradigandir (for Uyghur equivalent) indicating likelihood; probably this is a discussion for the last section, but need to be careful about phrasing in this section, because of the later qualification]] The logic closely matches several constructions in Central Asian Turki. For instance, in Uzbek: u boradigan ekan, '(s)he is likely to go'.

- *JP: check Uyghur manuals: there may be another way to express a similar idea*

In Iranian Persian, which has no direct parallel to this mode, the idea would be expressed with an additional clause (just like in English): احتمال دارد که او برود, 'it is likely that (s)he will go'.

Examples

> bukh: اگر بلوا شود البته از طرف تاشکند و بخارا عسکر **می آمده گی است**

uzb: Agar (bir) balo bo'lsa Toshkent va Buxoro tarafidan askarlar **keladigan ekan**, albatta.

fars:

- *LS: please suggest a translation (with a qualifying word making it clear that می آید (that the army "will come") is a conjectural prediction, not a certainty*

eng: If there is an uprising, then an army **will surely come** from Tashkent and Bukhara

Comments:

This letter was written during the uprising of the Turkmen tribes around Kerki against the Soviets in 1919: the writers warn that Bolshevik abuses have driven the population to take up arms.

Note البته, 'certainly', alongside the conjectural form: the mode marks a presumption or prediction, not doubt.

In the same passage the writers use the plain present-future for their own actions and those of the local people (فقرایان نیز در بلشویک مقابل می شوند, 'the people too will rise

> against the Bolsheviks'), and switch to می آمده گی است only for the troops from Tashkent and Bukhara: an outside force whose arrival they can only anticipate.

bukh: تُرکمانیه راضی نمی شود که بطرف کرکی صلات گذرد معلوم است که تا از طرف دولتخانه به تُرکمانیه یگان خبر صریح نوشد در هیچ صورت **نمی مانده گی اند**

uzb: Turkman ma'muriyyati askarlarning Kerki tomonga o'tishlariga rozi bo'lmaydi. Aniqki, Buxoro hukumat tomonidan Turkman ma'muriyatiga ochiq xabar berilmasa, ular **hech bir holatda ruxsat bermaydigan ekan**

fars:

eng: The Turkmens will not consent to soldiers passing toward Kerki. It is clear that, unless the government writes the Turkmens some explicit word, they **will under no circumstances allow it** .

Comments:

> A negated example. As in the previous example, a phrase of certainty (معلوم است که, 'it is clear that') accompanies the

> conjectural form: it marks a confident prediction, not doubt.

> ماندن here means 'to allow', like Uzbek qo'ymoq (see chapter [[]]).

> The letter comes from the same file as the previous example, on the Kerki uprising of 1919.

bukh: در میانه یگان هفته داخل ولایت چهارجوی **میشده گی است**

uzb: Bir hafta orasida Chorjuy viloyatida **bo'ladigan ekan**.

fars: ضرف یک هفته داخل ولایت چهارجوی بشود **احتمال دارد که**

eng: **He is likely to be in** Chorjuy province within a week

Comments:

bukh: دیگر از وجه اسیران در ایّام محاربه بوده گی امارت پناه سید بیک بی دادخواه همراه میر حیدر خواجه میر بدالف جهت پرسدین مأمور شده آمده بودند که گفت گذارش را شنیده رفتند **معلوم میکرده گی اند**

uzb: Shuningdek, urush paytida bo'lgan asirlar xususida, hokim Sayyid Bek-biy Dodxoh va Mir Haydar Xoja Mir Badalov bilan birga

so'rishtirishga amr bo'lganni uchun kelganlar. Ular so'zlashib eshitganlarini **xabar beradigan ekanlar**.

fars:

eng: As for the captives taken during the fighting: Sayyid Bek Biy Dadkhwah, together with Mir Haydar Khwaja [and] Mir Badalov, had been deputed to inquire. They heard the account and left, and **will [presumably] report it** .

Comments:

Here the form anticipates a report that has not yet been made: the envoys have heard the account and gone, and will presumably make it known.

امارت پناه, 'refuge of the emirate', is an honorific title of Sayyid Bek Biy, not a reference to the emirate itself; پرسدین is a spelling of پرسیدن, 'to inquire'.

> bukh: بفقرایان امان قوتنی تعیین کنانیده شد که ماله و اماج و دیگر چیزیکه گرفته گی باشند برده می سپاریده گی اند

> uzb: Amon-Qutan fuqarolariga tayinlab aytildiki, agar ular omoch va mola hamda boshqa narsalarni olgan bo'lsalar **topshiradigan ekanlar**.

> fars:

> eng:

Comments:

> In context (تعیین کنانیده شد که, 'it was arranged that') the form expresses an instruction: 'they are to bring back and hand over'.

> Note also گرفته گی باشند, the -gi participle with the subjunctive of 'to be': 'whatever they may have taken'.

bukh: که بخذمتشان فرستادم **میرسیده گی بود** یکخط بجنابشان

uzb: Janoblariga **yetkaziladigan** bir xat bor edi, uni xizmatlariga yubordim.

fars:

eng: There was a letter that **was to reach** to you, sir, which I have sent on.

Comments:

> With بود, the form means 'was supposed to' or 'was to', like Uzbek -adigan edi. This is the form described in the Uyghur reference below (Tomur), formed there with -idighan and the past copula.

> junāb-ishān is grammatically the third person, but is frequently used in documents as a polite address (not so differently than ustedes in Spanish, for instance).

bukh: وجه **می استاده گی شود** از وجه انچه بخارا گنهکار از روی تعامل بحبس بخارا گردانید

uzb: Buxoro holatida, odatga ko'ra, gunohkor Buxoro qamoqxonasida **turadigan bo'lsa**; shu xususda javob qaytaring.

fars:

eng: As for the Bukhar: by custom, if the criinal **should remain** in the Bukharan prison, reply accordingly.

Comments:

> This sentence comes from a brief, shorthand remark scribbled on the back of a document, instructing how to proceed.

> The conditional شود ('let it be'), further emphasizes the conjectural nature of the statement.

bukh: [پانزده هزار صوم] اگر **میفرستاده گی باشند** حاضر فرستانند جواب **نمیفرستاده باشند** گردانند که اینها باینجانب منتظر نشوند

uzb: Agar (o'n besh ming so'm) **yuboradigan bo'lsalar**, hozir yuborsinlar; **yubormaydigan bo'lsalar**, javob qaytarsinlar, toki bular meni kutib qolmasinlar.

fars:

eng: If they **are going to send** (fifteen thousand som), let them send them now. If they **are not going to send** (them) , let them reply, so that these people don't wait on me.

Comments:

Taken out of context, this sentence is a mess of pronouns; but it further illustrates conjectural nature of the verb form. With اگر after باشد, the form states a condition about someone's intention, like Uzbek -adigan bo'lsa.

Note that the negative drops گی (نمیفرستاده باشند), so that it looks like the more common form described in the explanation.

bukh: موسی بای نام آدم بیچاره بصلاح از عهدهٔ آقسقالی **میبرامیده گی میباشد**

uzb: Muso boy ismli bechora, yaxshi odam oqsoqollikning uddasidan **chiqadigan kishidir**.

fars:

eng: Musa Bay, a decent man of modest means, **is capable of** handling the office of aqsaqal.

Comments:

With میباشد, the form describes what someone is like or is able to do. از عهده برآمدن, 'to be equal to [a task]', is a common idiom in the documents, and Uzbek has the same expression (uddasidan chiqmoq).

bukh: در واقع از موضع قمرباط بودنش راست باشد البته خویش تبار **داشته گیست**

uzb: Haqiqatan Qumrabot ekani rost bo'lsa, albatta qarindosh-urug'lari **bor bo'ladigandir**.

fars:

eng: If it is true that she is from Qumrabot, she **must surely have** relatives.

Comments:

> Without می, the form expresses an inference: here, about a present state, from what is known of the woman's origin. Note again البته alongside the conjectural form.

References

- Persian / Tajik: Perry (245-246) calls this form "Present-Future Conjectural," which "expresses a conjecture about a potential or current (habitual or iterated) action."

- Uyghur: Tomur (360-363). What Hahn calls "Present-Future Obligatory" (-idighan + -di + personal suffix, e.g. kelidigandimän "I am supposed to come") is treated by Tomur as the Past Imperfect Tense Predicate Form, formed by attaching the Past Tense of the Direct Judgment Copula (-idi) to the Imperfect Participle/Adverbial (-digan forms). This form can be used to indicate "an intention, plan or agreement about carrying out an action prior to a certain matter" (361).